

DOINGG@UNION.EDU

COURSE: CSC106 CAN COMPUTERS THINK?

SELF

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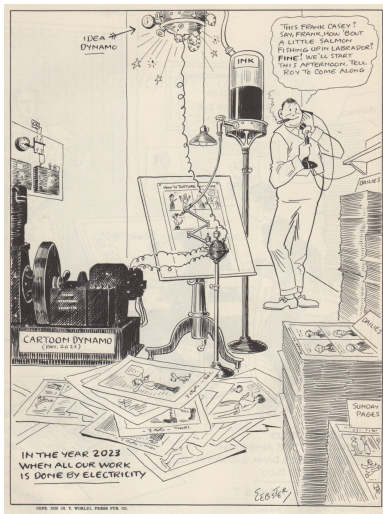
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The course website for [CSC106](#), part of the Union College [CS curriculum](#). Here you can find our weekly schedule, assignments and resources.

Announcements

Office Hours

- Student/Office Hours:
 - Steinmetz 217
 - Monday 4:00 pm - 5:30 pm

- Thursday 3:00 pm – 4:30 pm
- subject to change, check course website for most up-to-date schedule
- drop-in or schedule a 15 minute slot: <https://calendar.app.google/8bus6pfDvyphR9ar5>
- by appointment for another time or over zoom

Course Description

Can computers think? Is it possible to build intelligent machines? What does it mean for a machine to think or to be intelligent? Why, or why not, would we want intelligent machines? To what extent do we already have them? How do they work? How do they impact our lives? What are their limitations? This course invites you to explore these questions and more.

This course is an introduction to the field of computer science with an artificial intelligence theme that does not assume you have prior experience with computer programming or computer science. It introduces basic algorithms, data structures and programming techniques. You will learn how computer scientists think about and solve problems by doing your own computer programming. This will give you an understanding of how the current technology for building intelligent machines works. In addition, you will read non-technical papers about artificial intelligence and the ethical questions raised by its use. You will reflect on the ways current computational systems often reinforce biases and can harm groups of people inequitably. And you will evaluate how the choices you are making when creating your own programs will affect future users.

If you're thinking about a CS or CPE major or minor, this course will give you a solid foundation to continue to *Programming on Purpose* (CSC 120), to *Data Structures* (CSC 151) and beyond. If you're a neuroscience major, it will help you see how scientists are using biological and neurological principles to model "behavior" in computers and it will teach you skills useful for processing experimental data. If you are thinking about another major or minor, this course will give you foundations to apply computing in whatever area you are interested in. And if you're here just because you're curious, that's great!

Assignments

HW 01

CSC106: Assignment 1 (0.25 pts)

- due Monday 4/6/26 by class time (1:50 pm)
- in-class notes from Friday: https://drive.google.com/file/d/1UW3fMha6Ki4dDR_sidpeiV-PDeBSFEPi/view?usp=sharing
 - examples of comments, importing turtle, variables and for loops
 - also includes link to turtle library documentation

Part 1

- [Intro Survey](#)
- Runestone Chapters 1-3 (we'll discuss in class next week starting Monday)

Part 2

- Practice Problems for Week 1: [HW01 instructions](#)
- Starter code: [winding_sandbar.json](#)
- Submit code on Gradescope
- bring written answers to class (0.25 engagement points awarded on these)
- Graded on effort/completion

Weekly Notes

Week 1

Notes from Week 1

- Day 1 (Mon): [Seymour Pappert Turtle Documentary](#)
 - [Turtle drawing activity](#) (0.25 pts)
- Day 2 (Wed): [Instructions for First Program Activity](#) (.25 pts)
- Day 3 — Lab (Thurs): [Reeborg activity: newspaper](#) (.25 pts)

Python Examples

- in-class examples from Friday: https://drive.google.com/file/d/1UW3fMha6Ki4dDR_sidpeiV-PDeBSFEpi/view?usp=sharing
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About

References

